

Being a digital citizen

Being a good citizen online is very similar to being a good citizen offline. The focus in both situations is on treating people and their property respectfully.

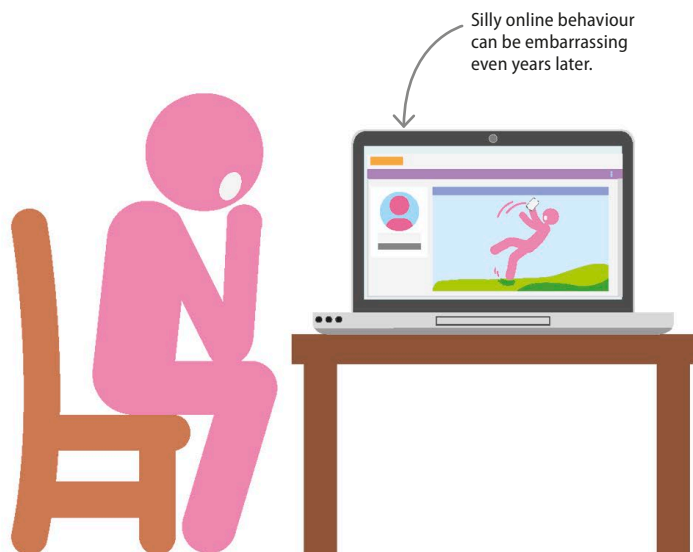
Digital citizens

More and more of our interactions with people for both work and leisure are taking place online. The behaviour of a good online citizen is all about being informed on the rules, regulations, and customs of the digital world, and following them. Good online citizens should welcome newcomers and report bullying or other bad behaviour to relevant authorities.

▷ Online identity

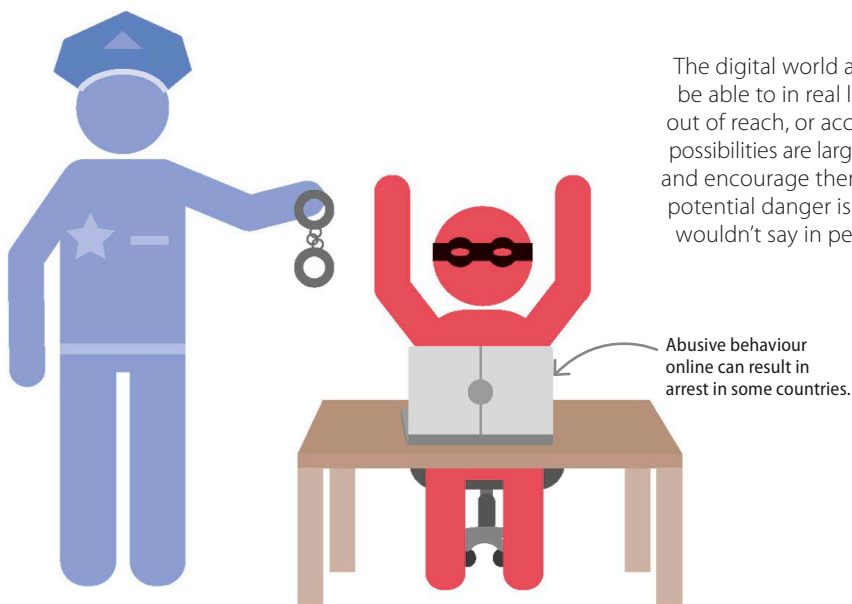
Being a good citizen online helps build an online identity and reputation. An online identity and good reputation can be undermined by unpleasant, abusive, or dangerous online behaviour, which can stick around for many years.

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Digital world

The digital world allows people to do things that they wouldn't be able to in real life, such as contacting people who would be out of reach, or accessing information and research. While these possibilities are largely positive, they can affect people's behaviour and encourage them to act in ways they normally wouldn't. One potential danger is the temptation for people to say things they wouldn't say in person. It's also easy for remarks intended to be humorous to be taken seriously.



◁ Digital law

Many people are not aware that their behaviour in the digital world can break the law of the country they are living in, or of another country. This is an increasingly common problem on social media and has even led to people being prosecuted.